Fresh pasta by hand

La sfoglia fatta a mano

All you need is "00" flour, eggs, a fork and a rolling pin. Allow 1 egg and 100 g of flour per person. Set aside about an hour, including 30 minutes of resting.

You will need

- 100 g "00" flour per person, plus extra for dusting
- 1 large egg per person
- A wooden board or clean worktop
- A fork, a rolling pin and a sharp knife

Step by step

1. **Make a well.** Pile the flour on the board and make a wide hollow in the middle. Crack the eggs into it.
2. **Mix with a fork.** Beat the eggs, slowly pulling in flour from the inside wall, until it is too thick to stir.
3. **Knead for 10 minutes.** Push with the heel of your hand, fold and turn, until the dough is smooth and springs back when pressed.
4. **Rest for 30 minutes.** Wrap the dough. Resting relaxes the gluten so it rolls out thin without shrinking back.
5. **Roll it thin.** Roll from the centre outwards, turning the dough a quarter turn each time, until you can almost see the board through it.
6. **Dry briefly.** Leave the sheet for 5 to 10 minutes so it is no longer sticky, but still soft enough to fold.
7. **Cut.** Roll the sheet up loosely and slice: 6 mm for tagliatelle, 1 cm for pappardelle, 3 mm for tagliolini.
8. **Cook.** Shake the ribbons loose and boil in plenty of salted water for 2 to 3 minutes.

If something goes wrong

- **Too dry and crumbly?** Wet your hands and keep kneading; add water a few drops at a time.
- **Too sticky?** Dust with flour, a spoonful at a time.
- **Shrinks when rolled?** Let it rest for 10 more minutes, then try again.

Storing

Dust the cut pasta with flour or semolina and curl it into nests. Cook within a day, or freeze the nests on a tray, then bag them. Cook from frozen, adding a minute.